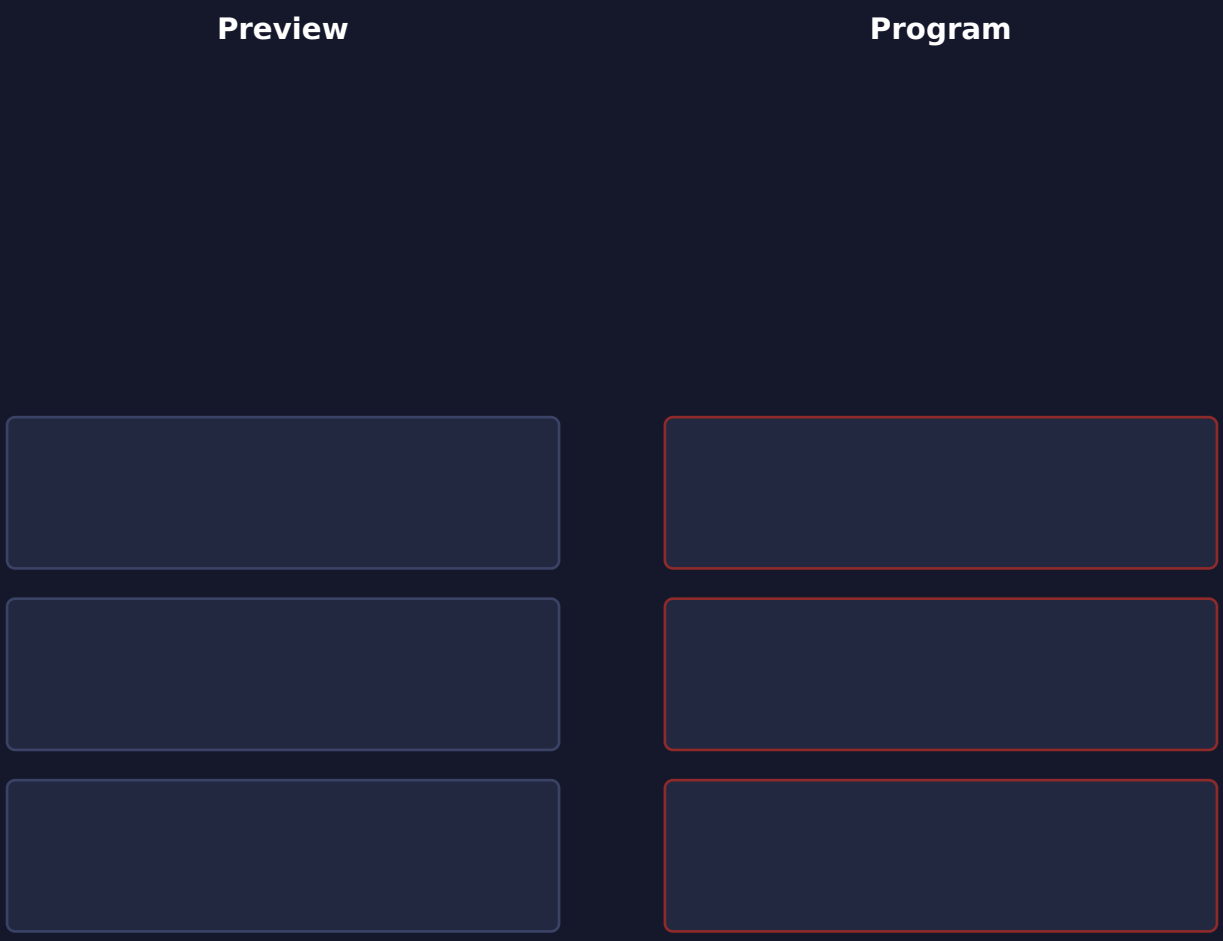


Multidestination Studio

User Guide · Version 1.1.9

A plugin for OBS Studio · Windows, macOS, Linux

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1. What is Multidestination Studio?

At a conference, a concert or a church service, the video team rarely sends the same picture everywhere. The LED wall behind the stage, a pair of projectors on the side screens, the confidence monitor for the speaker and the live stream all need different content, at different resolutions, switched at the same moment.

Multidestination Studio is a free plugin for OBS Studio that does exactly this. It adds independent **destinations** to OBS, each with its own canvas, resolution, Preview and Program, and lets you run all of them from one studio window with a single **Transition**. You keep everything you already know from OBS: sources, filters, transitions, audio, streaming and recording.

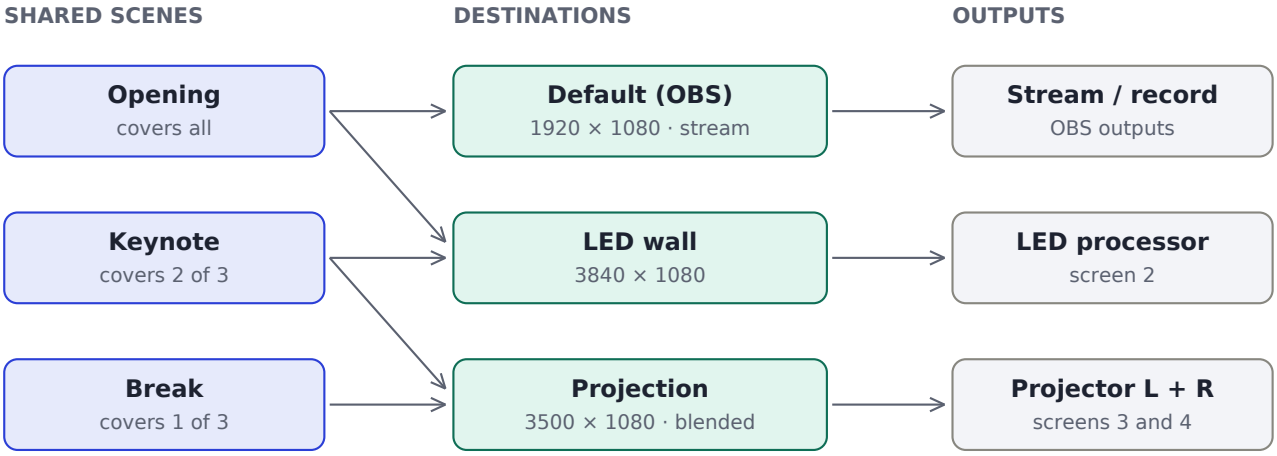
What it gives you

- **Several outputs, one operator.** Every destination has its own picture, but one scene list and one Transition drive them all.
- **A different layout per screen.** The same scene can show a full-screen camera on the stream, a wide graphic on the LED wall and nothing at all on the projectors.
- **Projector blending built in.** Spread one destination across several projectors with soft-edge blending, gamma, black level and keystone correction.
- **A safe live output.** Changes you prepare in Preview never touch what is on air, unless you decide to edit the Program directly.
- **Cues** (optional): play several scenes one after the other, with waits, per-scene transitions and Auto-follow at the end of a video.
- **Companion and Stream Deck**: a ready-made Companion module with buttons for scenes, transitions, settings, cues and a group source selector.

Requirements

Item	Requirement
OBS Studio	Version 31.1 or later
Systems	Windows 10/11 (64-bit), macOS (Apple Silicon and Intel), Ubuntu 24.04 (x86_64)
Hardware	One graphics card able to render every destination at your OBS frame rate. Each extra screen used for output must be connected to the computer.
Companion (optional)	A recent Bitfocus Companion, to control the studio from a Stream Deck (chapter 12).
Languages	English, French, Norwegian (Bokmål)

2. Key concepts



Each scene covers some destinations. Each destination keeps its own layout of the scene and feeds its own outputs.

Concept	Meaning
Destination	An independent video output with its own canvas and resolution: a screen, an LED wall, a group of blended projectors. The **default destination** is the OBS main canvas, the one OBS streams and records.
Scene	Scenes are shared. A scene lists the destinations it **covers**; each covered destination has its own version of the scene, with its own sources and layout.
Folder	Scenes can be arranged in folders. A folder only organises the list: it is never taken live.
Preview / Program	As in the OBS Studio Mode: Preview shows what is coming next, Program shows what is live. Each destination has both.
Transition	Sends the Preview scene to Program on every destination it covers, at the same moment, with the OBS transition. **Quick transitions** and the **T-bar** do the same with another transition or by hand.
Lock	A locked destination ignores transitions and keeps its current Program.
Modify PGM	Program shows a copy of the scene taken live. Modify PGM lets you edit that live picture directly; the changes are also kept in the scene.
Output blending	A destination split across several outputs (usually projectors) whose overlaps are softly blended to look like one seamless image.
Cue	A list of scenes taken live one after the other, each with its own waits and transition.

Good to know. A destination that a scene does not cover is not affected when that scene is taken: it simply keeps showing its current Program. This lets you change one screen without touching the others.

3. Installation and first launch

Close OBS, then install the package for your system, downloaded from the project's GitHub Releases page.

System	Package	Notes
Windows	multidestination-studio-1.1.9-windows-x64-installer.exe	The installer is not code-signed: Windows SmartScreen or Defender may ask you to confirm.
macOS	Universal .pkg package	Not signed: open System Settings → Privacy & Security → Open Anyway.
Ubuntu	multidestination-studio-1.1.9-x86_64-linux-gnu.deb	sudo apt install ./ followed by the file name.
Companion	obs-studio-4.0.0-multidestination.3.tgz	Optional: the Companion module (chapter 12).

Start OBS. A **Multidestination Studio** button appears in the OBS **Controls** dock, next to **Studio Mode**. The same command is in the **Tools** menu, and you can assign a hotkey to it in OBS Settings → Hotkeys.

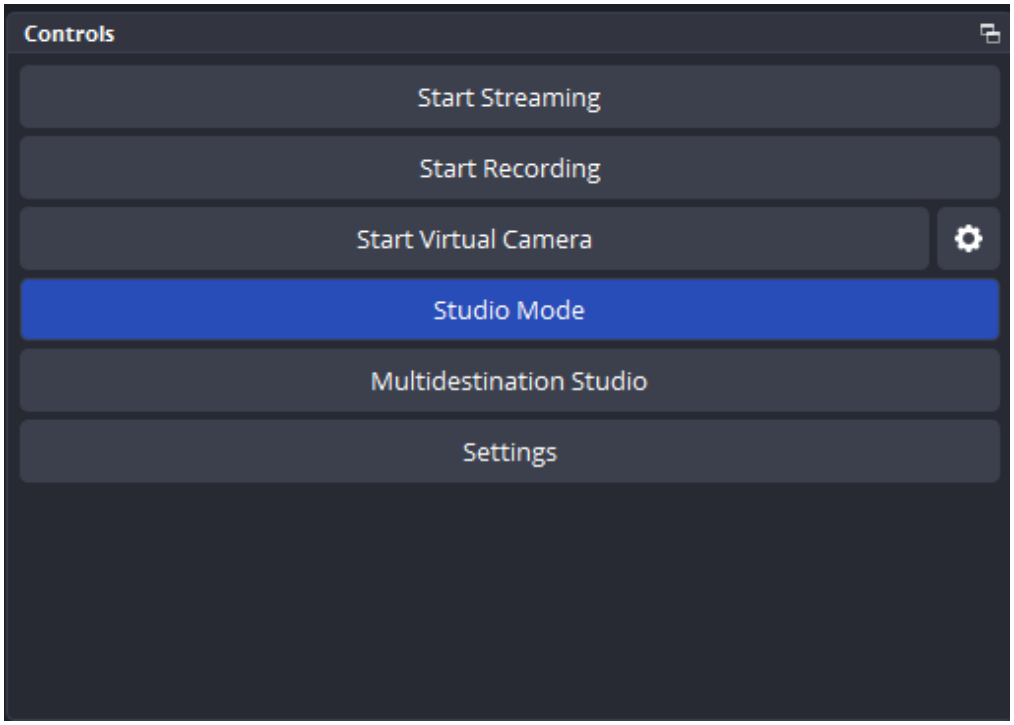


Figure 1. The Multidestination Studio button in the OBS Controls dock.

Multidestination Studio opens full screen on Windows and Linux, and in a large window on macOS. When it opens, OBS Studio Mode is switched on (and switched off again when you leave, if it was off), so that the default destination also has a real Preview and Program.

The studio is a window of its own, like an OBS projector: it has its own entry in the taskbar (the Dock and Mission Control on macOS). After minimizing it, click that entry to come back. To leave the studio, use **File → Exit Multidestination Studio**, the **Quit** button in the top-right corner (full screen), the **Exit** button in the Controls dock, or **Esc**.

OBS windows opened from the studio (source properties, filters, transition properties) open over it. When the OBS window is restored after being minimized, the studio comes back in front; to work in the OBS window, click it or choose it with Alt+Tab (Cmd+Tab on macOS).

> **Tip.** To have the studio open automatically every time OBS starts, turn on **Configuration Settings → Startup Settings → Launch Multidestination Studio on startup**. It then opens in full screen, also on macOS.

4. A tour of the studio

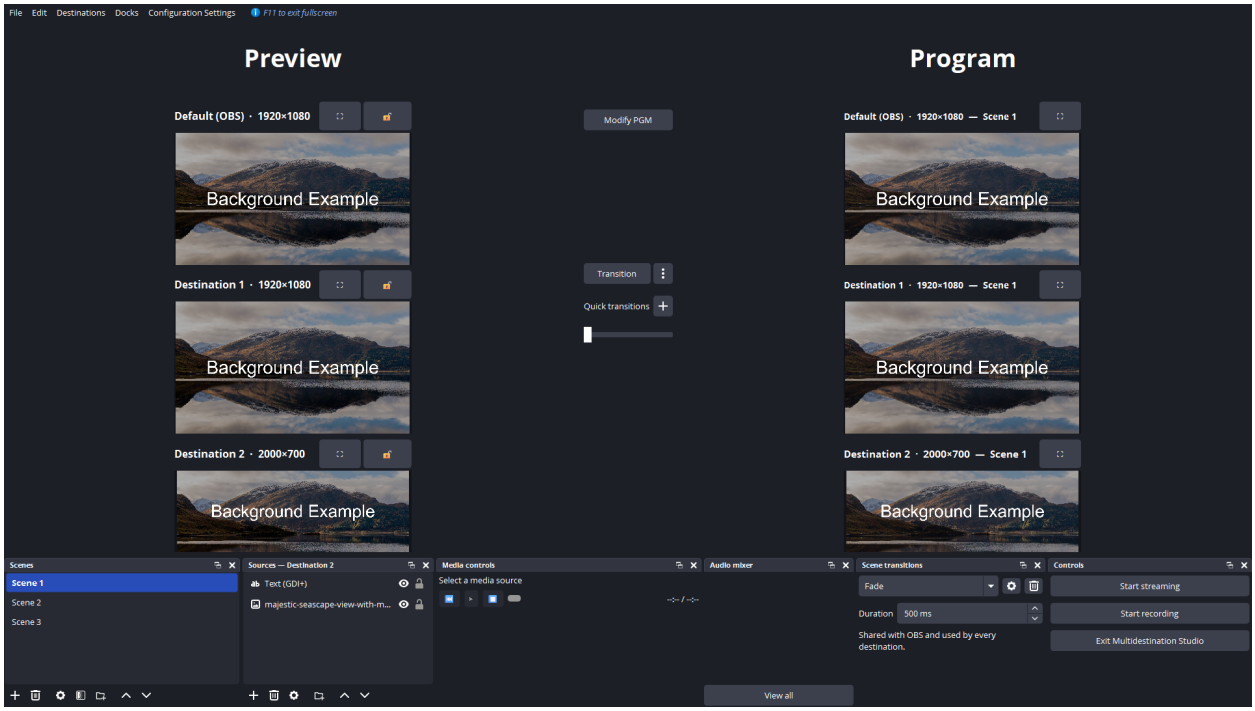


Figure 2. The Multidestination Studio window with three destinations.

Menus

Menu	Contents
File	Exit Multidestination Studio.
Edit	Undo, copy and paste, group, remove, transform, order, properties and filters for the selected source (chapter 7).
Destinations	One submenu per destination, Manage destinations, Output blending, New destination (chapters 5 and 10).
Docks	Show or hide each dock, Reset docks, Fullscreen (F11).
Show	New show, Save show, Save show as, Load show, Import, Export (chapter 14).
Configuration Settings	After a transition, Destinations shown, Cues, Startup Settings, Language (chapter 13).

Next to the menus, an information hint reminds you that **F11** switches full screen on or off. In full screen, moving the mouse to the top-right corner reveals **Minimize**, **Exit fullscreen** and **Quit**; they disappear when the mouse moves away.

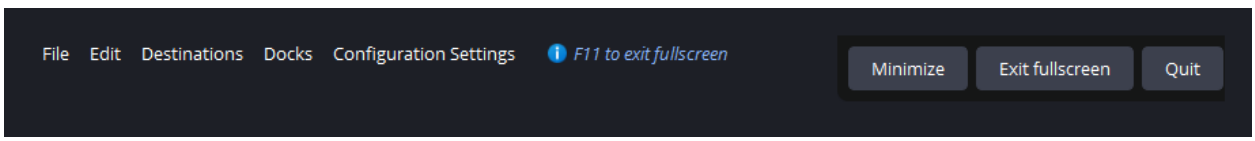


Figure 3. Top-right window controls in full screen, and the F11 hint next to the menus.

Preview and Program

The **Preview** column (left) and the **Program** column (right) show one tile per destination, stacked and scaled to fit the window. Each tile has a header with the destination name and resolution (in Program, also the scene on air) and two buttons:

- **Enlarge** shows only this destination, much larger, for precise placement. **Show all** brings the other destinations back.
- **Lock** (Preview only) keeps this destination out of transitions.

When space is short, the buttons shrink to their icons and the name text scales down so it always remains complete. Between the columns are **Modify PGM**, then **Transition** with its ⋮ menu, the **Quick transitions** and the **T-bar** (chapter 8).



Figure 4. A tile header: destination name, Enlarge and Lock (unlocked and locked).

Docks

By default the docks sit side by side at the bottom of the window: **Scenes**, **Sources**, **Cues** (when the Cues feature is on), **Media controls**, **Audio mixer**, **Scene transitions** and **Controls**. They can be moved, resized, floated or closed like OBS docks; the arrangement is saved with your scene collection. **Docks → Reset docks** restores the default layout. The Scenes, Sources and Cues docks look and behave like those of OBS, with the same toolbar icons.

Dock	Role
Scenes	The shared scene list, with folders: add, remove, settings, filters, new folder, reorder.
Sources	Sources of the active tile (the destination you clicked last), with groups: add, remove, properties, new folder, reorder; eye and lock on each source.
Cues	Optional: cues and their scenes, with live status (chapter 9).
Media controls	Play / pause, restart and stop the selected media source.
Audio mixer	Meters, faders, mute and monitoring for the active audio sources.
Scene transitions	Choose the OBS transition, its duration and properties, or remove it.
Controls	Start or stop streaming and recording, exit the studio.

5. Destinations

Creating a destination

1. Choose **Destinations → New destination…**.
2. Enter a **name** and a **resolution**. Choosing an **output screen** fills in the resolution of that screen automatically.
3. Tick **Add to existing scenes** if the new destination should appear in every scene you already have. Leave it unticked to add it to scenes one by one.
4. Click **Create**. The destination appears in Preview and Program for every scene that covers it.

When **All destinations, all the time** is on (chapter 13), a note under the checkbox reminds you that the new destination will be visible under every scene; where it was not added, it shows **Not in this scene** and nothing is placed on it.

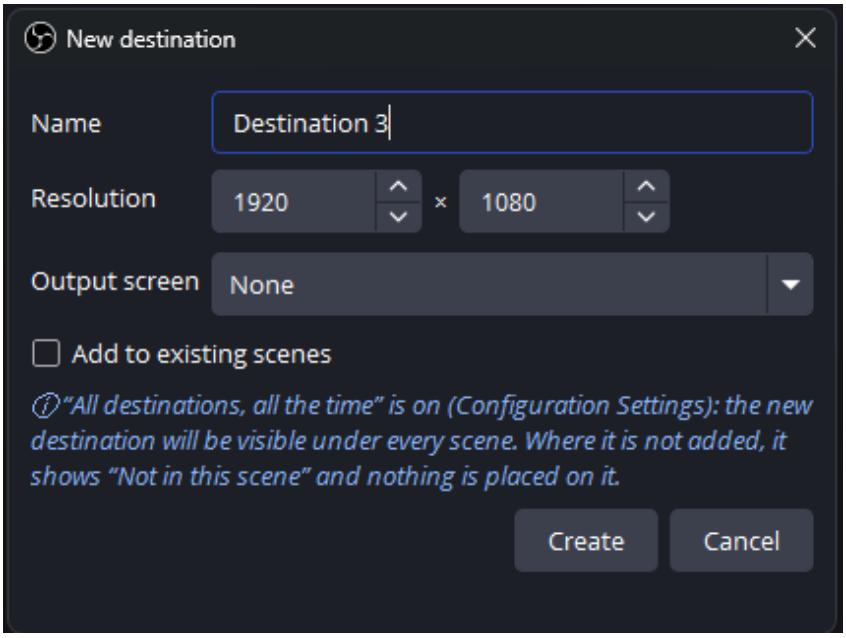


Figure 5. The New destination dialog, with the note shown when All destinations, all the time is on.

The Destinations menu

Each destination has its own submenu:

Command	What it does
Settings…	Rename, change the resolution or the output screen.
Output blending…	Split this destination across several projectors (chapter 10).
Open fullscreen	Shows the Program of the destination full screen on its output screen. For a blended destination: one full-screen window per projector.
Open windowed	Shows the Program in a normal window, for checking or for capture.
Close projection	Closes the full-screen or windowed output.
Delete	Deletes the destination and its layouts in every scene, after confirmation.

A full-screen output stays on top of its screen, whatever you do in OBS or in the studio, and does not take the focus. If its screen is disconnected, the output hides and comes back by itself when the screen returns. Click an output to give it the focus: **Esc** then closes it, and a double-click switches between full screen and window. The mouse pointer is hidden on output screens. On macOS, an output covers its whole screen, menu bar and Dock included, and stays in place on every Space: another app in full screen or a switch between OBS windows does not move or hide it. Leave “Displays have separate Spaces” as you prefer.

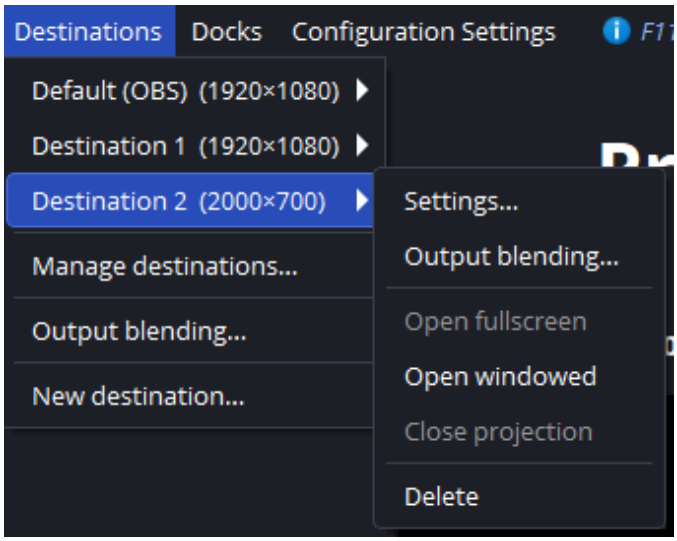


Figure 6. The Destinations menu with a destination submenu open.

Managing all destinations

Destinations → Manage destinations… shows every destination in one window. Select a destination on the left to change its name, resolution, output screen and lock, and to tick or untick the scenes it appears in; the window shows how many scenes cover it. Click **Apply** to save the changes; unticking a scene asks for confirmation, because the layout of that scene on this destination is deleted. The same window gives direct access to Output blending, fullscreen projection, Delete (Deactivate or Activate for the default destination) and New destination.

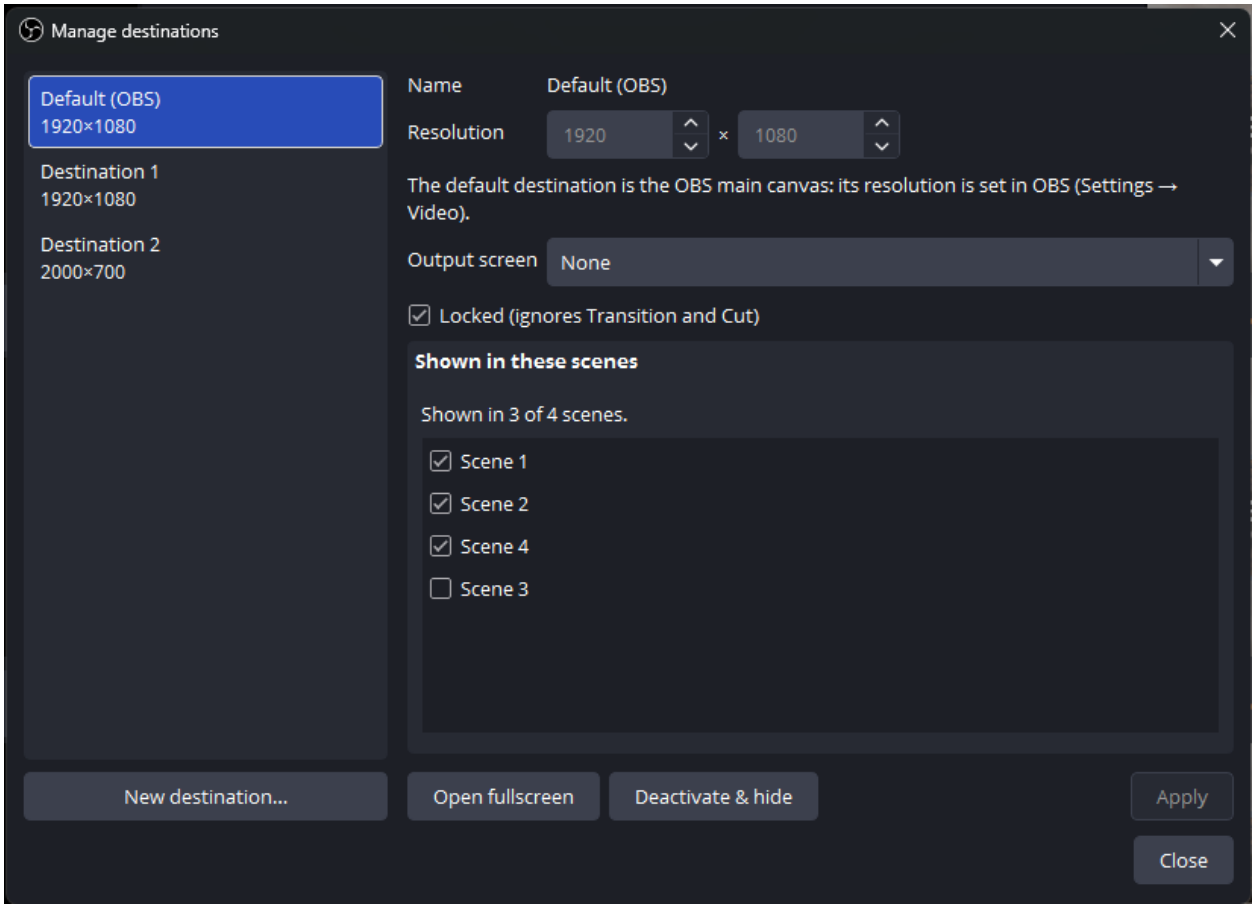


Figure 7. The Manage destinations window.

The default destination

The default destination is the OBS main canvas: its resolution is set in OBS Settings → Video, and it is what OBS streams and records. If you do not need it, choose **Deactivate & hide** in its submenu: it disappears from the studio, its scenes are kept for later, and streaming and recording are disabled until you reactivate it.

6. Scenes

Scenes are shared by all destinations. A scene decides **which destinations it covers**; each covered destination has its own version of the scene with its own sources.

Creating a scene

Click **+** in the Scenes dock. Give the scene a name and tick the destinations under **Show this scene on** (all are ticked by default). Scenes created directly in OBS, by a Stream Deck or through obs-websocket open the same dialog.

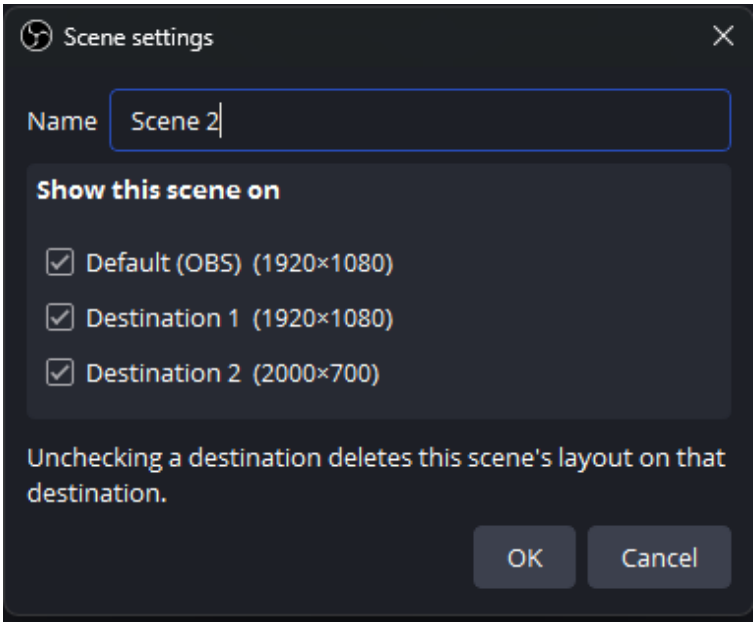


Figure 8. The scene dialog with its list of destinations.

Changing which destinations a scene covers

Double-click a scene, use the gear button, or right-click → **Name and destinations…** to open the same dialog. Unticking a destination deletes the layout of that scene on that destination, so you are asked to confirm.

Selecting and organising

- **Select**: click a scene. Ctrl + click (Cmd + click on macOS) adds or removes a scene from the selection; Shift + click selects everything between two scenes; dragging from an empty area of the list selects several scenes.
- **Move**: press on a scene and drag it, use the ↑ and ↓ buttons, or right-click for Move up, Move down, Move to top and Move to bottom. The order is shared with the OBS scene list.
- **Rename**: F2 (Enter on macOS), or right-click → Rename.
- **Filters**: the filter button opens the OBS filters of the selected scene.
- **Remove**: press **Delete** or use the bin button; a confirmation is always shown.
- **Duplicate**: right-click → **Duplicate…**, give a name and choose the destinations. The copy has the same sources, placed the same way, in each checked destination that shows the original.

Folders

Folders keep long scene lists tidy. The folder button (or right-click → **New folder** / **Group into a folder**) creates a folder; the selected scenes, and the scenes of selected folders, go into it. Drag scenes into and out of folders; the arrow at the start of a folder opens or closes it. **Remove folder** keeps its scenes. Folders only organise the list: when a folder is selected, **Transition** and the quick transitions are disabled and a short note explains why.

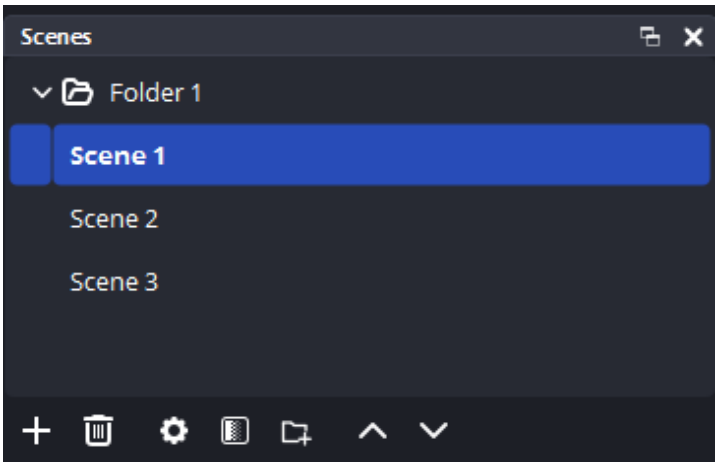


Figure 9. The Scenes dock with a folder open.

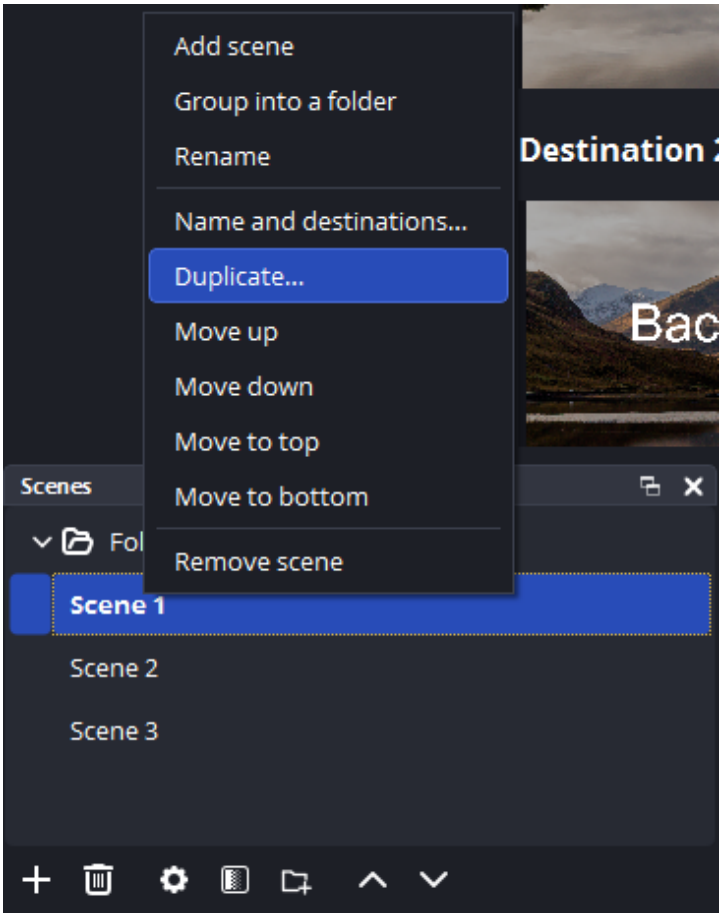


Figure 10. Right-click on a scene: Duplicate… asks for the name of the copy and its destinations.

When a scene does not cover a destination

By default every destination stays visible. When the selected scene does not cover a destination, its Preview tile is hatched, framed in red and marked **Not in this scene**; its Program keeps showing what is live. You can instead show only the destinations of the selected scene (chapter 13).

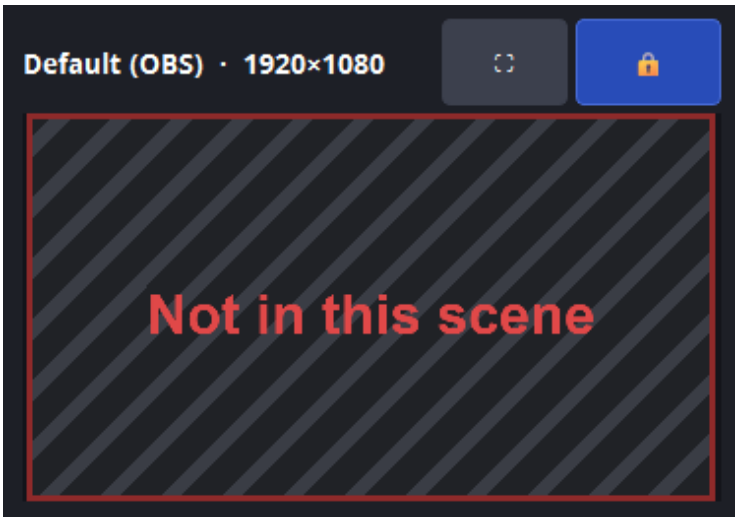


Figure 11. A destination that the selected scene does not cover.

7. Sources and editing

Click a Preview tile to make it the **active tile**: the Sources dock then lists the sources of that destination for the selected scene, and a discreet green frame marks the tile. Each source shows the icon of its type, as in OBS.

Adding sources

- **+** in the Sources dock lists every OBS source type, plus existing sources and other scenes.
- Drag image or video files from your computer onto a destination tile. They are added at their original size, centred; a new video shows its first frame without playing.

Frames

A **frame** is an empty area of a destination where you drop files. **+** in the Sources dock → **Frame…** asks for its name, width and height (the size of the destination by default) and adds it, centred, to the active destination.

- The frame is an OBS group holding an invisible, locked frame source. In the studio it shows as a dotted blue outline, even when empty; nothing of it appears on the outputs.
- Drop image or video files from your computer onto the frame: each one is put in the frame's group, fitted to the frame with its proportions kept and centred. Several files dropped are stacked, the last one on top.
- Click inside the frame to select its group, then move or resize it like any group: its contents follow. The frame size can also be changed in the properties of the frame source.
- With Companion, the Group Source Selector of a frame cycles through the files in it; the frame source itself is not one of the choices.

Visibility, lock and folders

- The **eye** shows or hides a source; the **lock** stops it from being moved or resized with the mouse.
- The **folder** button creates a folder (an OBS group) with the selected sources in it, ready to be renamed. **Edit → Group selected sources** (Ctrl+G) and **Ungroup** (Ctrl+Shift+G) do the same from the menu.
- Drag sources into and out of groups, or right-click a source → **Move to group** / **Remove from group**: the source keeps its place on screen. Selecting a source inside a group edits only that source, also with the handles in the Preview.
- Right-click a source → **Crop…**: the whole source is shown with the cropped areas darkened. Drag the edges or corners of the frame, or drag inside it to move it, or type the values in pixels. Changes are applied live; Ctrl+Z (Cmd+Z) undoes in the dialog, **No crop** removes the crop, **Cancel** restores the previous one.

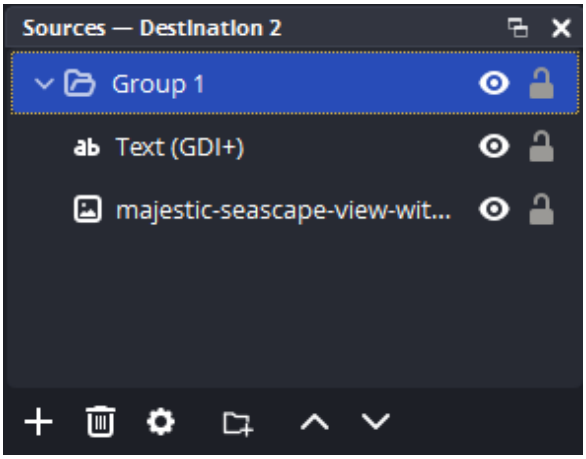


Figure 12. The Sources dock with a group, the eye and the lock.

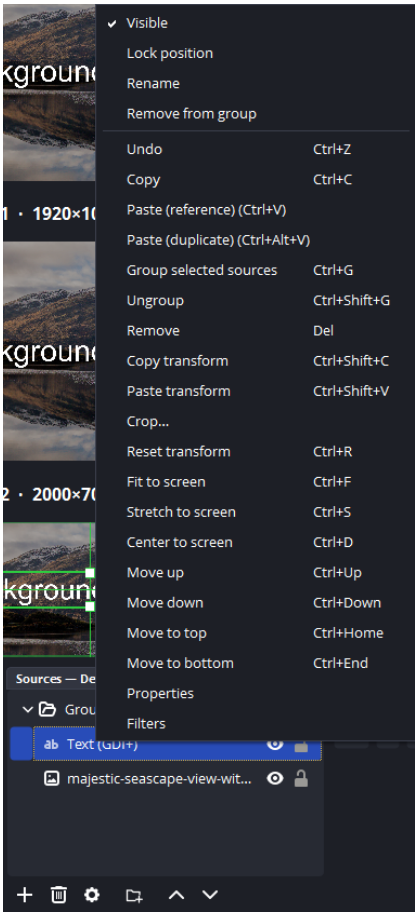


Figure 13. Right-click on a source in a group: Move to group / Remove from group, Crop… and the paste shortcuts.

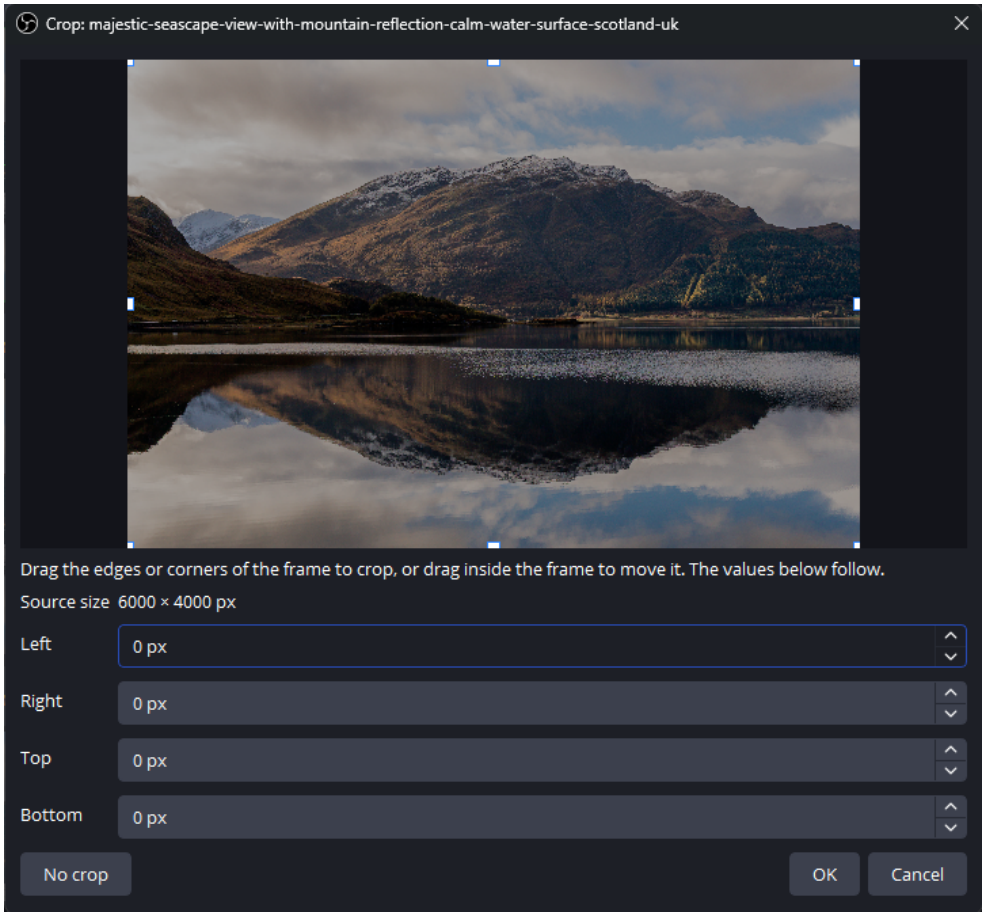


Figure 14. The Crop dialog: the whole source with the cropped areas darkened and the frame handles.

Editing with the mouse

Action	How
Move	Drag the source. It snaps to the centre of the canvas; hold Ctrl to disable snapping.
Resize	Drag a corner or edge handle; the aspect ratio is kept. Hold Shift to resize freely.
Crop	Hold Alt and drag a handle, or right-click → Crop… (a preview of the whole source with handles, and the values in pixels; Ctrl+Z undoes in the dialog).
Nudge	Arrow keys move the selected source by one pixel (10 with Shift).
Several sources	Select them in the Sources dock (Ctrl + click or Shift + click), then drag one of them in the tile to move them together, or drag a handle of their common frame to resize them together.
Select	Click a source in the tile: the highest source under the cursor is selected alone, also inside a group; clicking inside a group but next to its sources selects the group. Ctrl + click (Cmd + click on macOS) selects the whole group. In the Sources dock, Ctrl + click and Shift + click select several sources; a right-click in the tile on one of them keeps the selection, so Fit, Stretch and Center apply to all.
Reorder	Drag sources in the Sources dock, or use ↑ / ↓ and the Edit → Order commands.
Rename	F2 (Enter on macOS), or right-click → Rename.

Selected sources have a green outline with handles; a source that goes beyond the canvas is outlined in orange. Clicking elsewhere in the window clears the outlines. A video that is not playing keeps a frame at its real size and can be edited like any other source.



Figure 15. Editing a source in Preview: selection handles and centre guides.

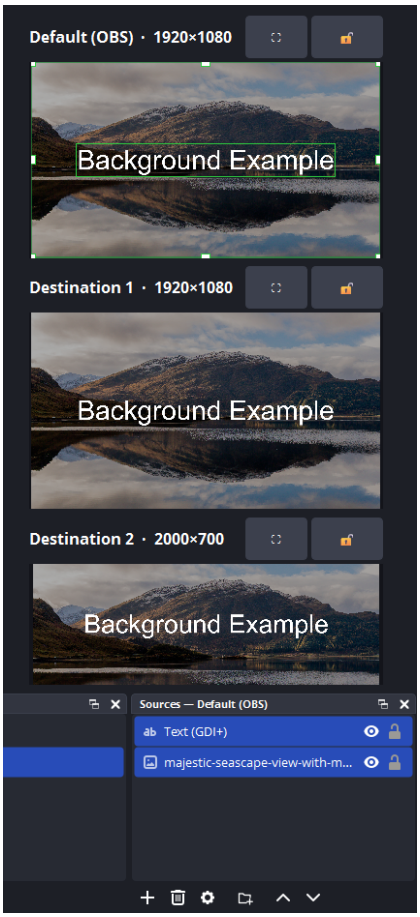


Figure 16. Several sources selected: an outline on each and handles on their common frame.

Edit menu and shortcuts

Command	Shortcut
Undo	Ctrl+Z
Copy / Paste (reference)	Ctrl+C / Ctrl+V
Paste (duplicate): an independent copy, with its filters	Ctrl+Alt+V (Cmd+Option+V on macOS). The right-click menu shows both paste shortcuts.
Group selected sources / Ungroup	Ctrl+G / Ctrl+Shift+G
Remove (with confirmation)	Delete or Backspace
Copy / Paste transform	Ctrl+Shift+C / Ctrl+Shift+V
Reset transform	Ctrl+R
Fit to screen (keeps the proportions) / Stretch to screen / Center to screen: on every selected source	Ctrl+F / Ctrl+S / Ctrl+D
Move up / down / to top / to bottom	Ctrl+↑ / Ctrl+↓ / Ctrl+Home / Ctrl+End
Properties, Filters	Edit menu, double-click or right-click

On macOS, use Cmd instead of Ctrl. Editing shortcuts work when the Preview or the Sources dock has the focus, so they never interfere with typing in other fields.

8. Going live

Transition

Select a scene: it appears in Preview on every destination it covers. Click **Transition** to send it to Program with the transition and duration chosen in the Scene transitions dock. All destinations switch at the same moment.

- A **locked** destination keeps its Program.
- A destination the scene does not cover keeps its Program.
- After the transition, the previous Program returns to Preview, as in OBS Studio Mode. The ⋮ menu next to Transition switches this on or off, and switches between all destinations and only those of the selected scene (the same settings as chapter 13).
- Hotkeys for **Transition**, **Cut** and opening the studio can be set in OBS Settings → Hotkeys (they start with "Multidestination Studio").

Switching scenes in the normal OBS window only changes the default destination; the other destinations are driven from Multidestination Studio (or from Companion, chapter 12).

Quick transitions

Quick transitions take the Preview to Program with a given transition and duration, without changing the transition of the Scene transitions dock. The list starts empty.

- **Add**: click **+** next to **Quick transitions**, set the duration at the bottom of the menu, then choose a transition type (Cut, Fade, Swipe, Slide, Stinger, Fade to Color, Luma Wipe, and the other types installed in OBS). Cut and Fade use the OBS built-in transitions; the other types open the OBS name and properties windows. The new quick transition is added under the others.
- **Use**: click the quick transition.
- **Edit or remove**: click its arrow for **Properties…**, the duration, or **Remove**.

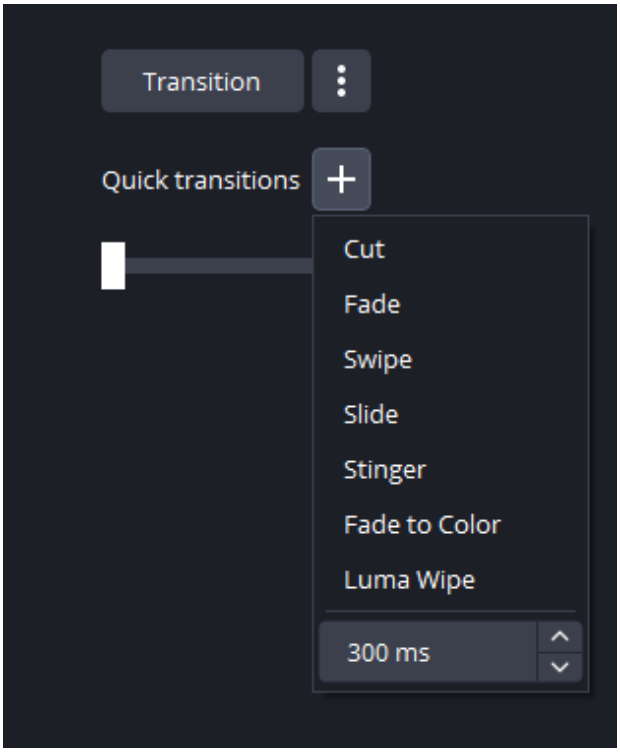


Figure 17. Transition and its ⋮ menu, quick transitions with the + menu open, and the T-bar.

T-bar

The T-bar under the quick transitions makes a manual transition on every destination. Drag its handle to the end to finish the transition, or back to the start to cancel it; released in between, the transition waits there. As in OBS, Cut and Stinger are replaced by a fade for the T-bar.

Editing what is live: Modify PGM

What is on air is a copy of the scene, so changes you make in Preview never reach the live output by accident. When you do need to fix something live, click **Modify PGM**: the button turns red and the Program tiles become editable with the same tools as Preview. Your changes are applied live and also saved into the scene. Click the button again to protect the Program.

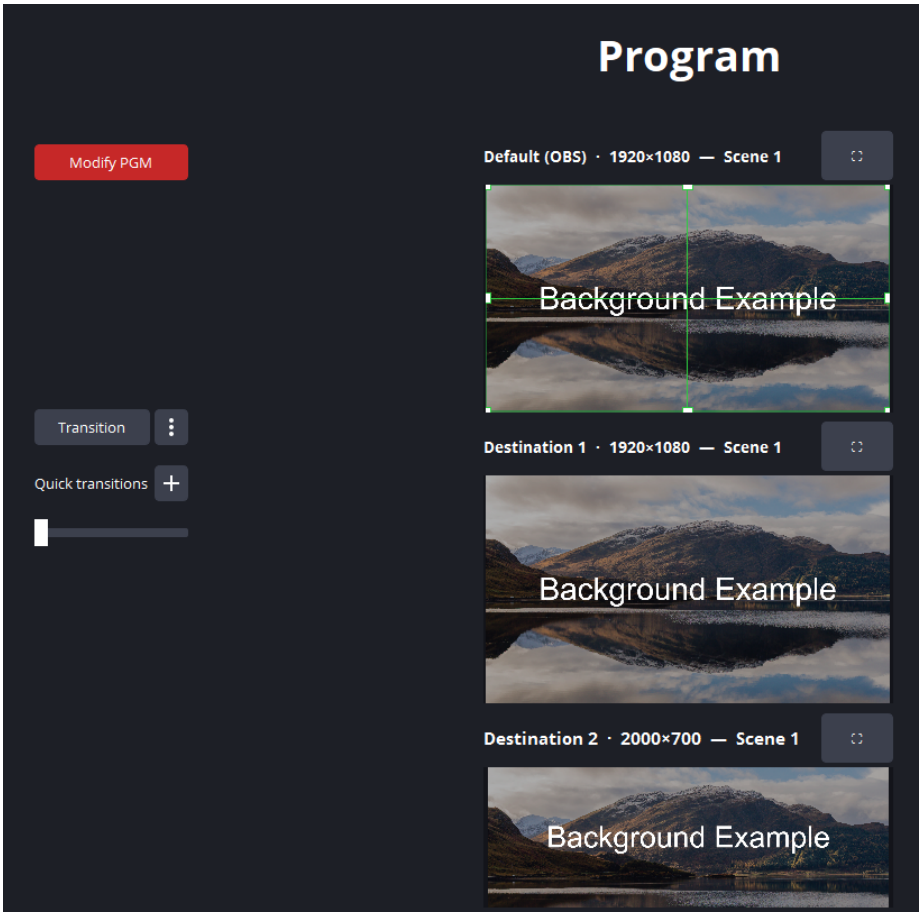


Figure 18. Modify PGM switched on: the button is red and the Program can be edited.

Groups in Preview and Program

The scene on air keeps its own copy of its groups. Showing another source of a group (the eye in the Sources dock, or the Companion group buttons) therefore changes only the Preview; your choice goes on air with the next transition. On the default destination this relies on the OBS Studio Mode setting **Duplicate scene** (on by default); without it, the OBS Program shows the scene itself and a group change is seen on air immediately.

9. Cues

A cue plays several scenes one after the other, like a cue list in show control software: for example a countdown video, then the opening graphic, then the camera. The feature is optional and off by default: turn it on with **Configuration Settings → Cues… → Activate Cues**. The Cues dock then appears between Sources and Media controls.

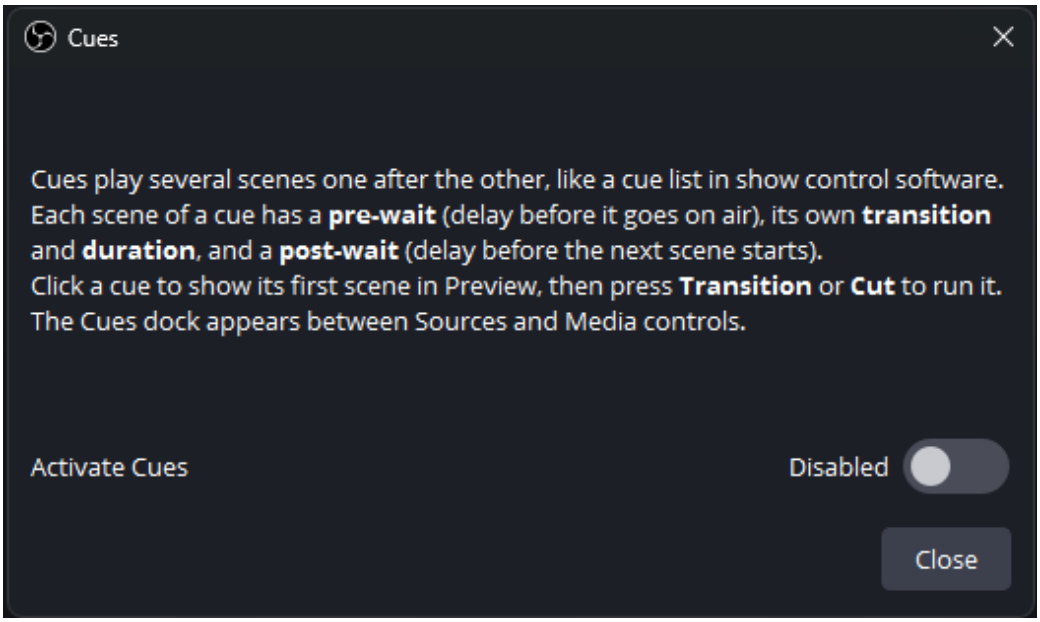


Figure 19. The Cues settings dialog.

Creating a cue

1. Optionally select, in the Scenes dock, the scenes the cue should start with.
2. Click **+** in the Cues dock. Give the cue a name.
3. For each scene, from top to bottom, set the columns described below. **Add scene**, **Remove scene**, **Move up** and **Move down** edit the list.
4. Click **Save**.

Column	Meaning
Scene	The scene taken live at this step.
Pre-wait	Delay before the scene goes live.
Transition	**Default** (the transition of the Scene transitions dock) or any OBS transition. The first scene has none of its own: it uses the transition that starts the cue.
Duration	Follows the transition, as in the OBS dock: with Default, the default duration (not editable); with Cut, greyed; with other transitions, editable (300 ms proposed).
Auto-follow	The next scene starts as soon as the video or audio of this scene ends, instead of after the post-wait. The media is searched in every destination.
Post-wait	Delay after the scene starts, before the next scene. It always lasts at least as long as the transition.

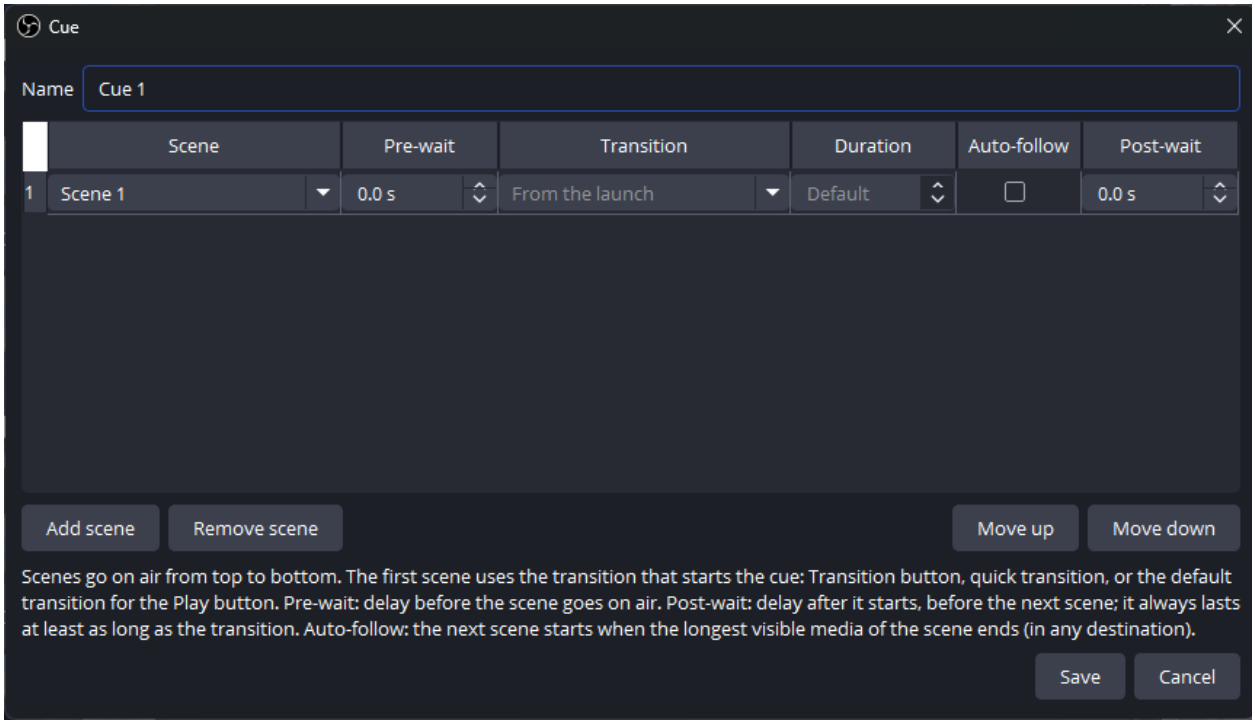


Figure 20. The cue editor.

Running a cue

- Click a cue: the cue is in Preview (the Preview title shows its name, its first scene is displayed). Press **Transition** or a **quick transition** to run it: its first scene uses that transition, then the scenes go live one after the other.
- The **Run** button runs the selected cue directly, with the default transition. **Stop** stops the cue with a fade to black on every unlocked destination.
- The running cue opens and its current scene is marked ▶, with its status: the pre-wait or post-wait countdown, or the media time (0:12 / 0:45) with Auto-follow.
- While a cue runs you can keep working: changing the Preview does not affect it. Putting a scene on air yourself (Transition, quick transition, T-bar, OBS, Companion) stops the cue.
- At the end of a cue, its last scene stays on air and the Preview is unchanged: the next take is up to the operator (or put the transition to a background in the cue itself).
- Delete (Backspace on a Mac keyboard) deletes the selected cue.

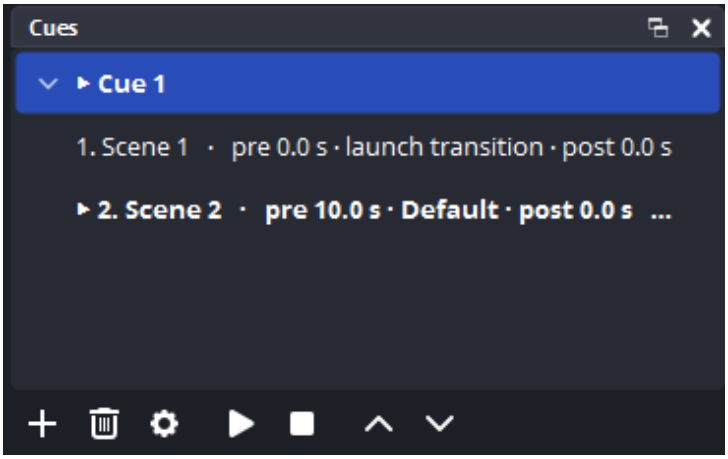


Figure 21. The Cues dock with a cue running.

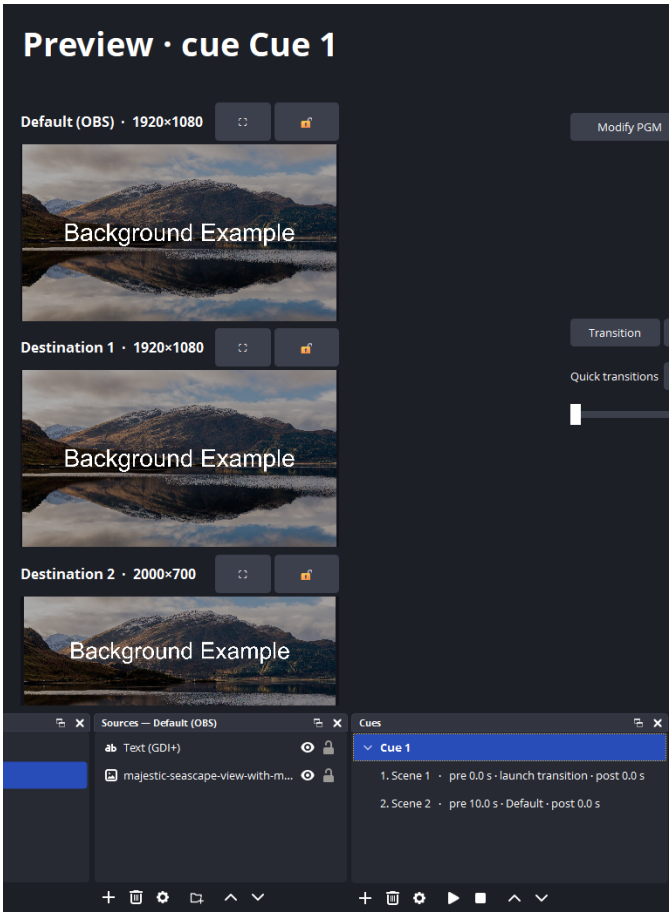


Figure 22. A cue in Preview: the Preview title shows the cue name.

Cues are saved with the scene collection. Double-click a cue to edit it; drag cues to reorder them.

10. Output blending

Output blending spreads one destination across several outputs, typically two or more projectors whose images overlap on a wide screen. In the overlap, each projector fades out softly so the audience sees one seamless picture.

Creating a blended destination

1. Choose **Destinations → Output blending…**.
2. Click **New output** for each projector and choose its **screen**.
3. Drag each output from the list onto the **layout** (or double-click it). An output starts with the shape of its screen and cannot leave the layout.
4. Set the **layout size**, for example 3500 × 1080 for two overlapping full-HD projectors. The outputs follow automatically. The layout size becomes the resolution of the destination.
5. Place the outputs so that they overlap; overlaps are hatched and blended automatically.
6. Give the destination a name ("Destination X" if left empty) and click **Save & Create destination**.

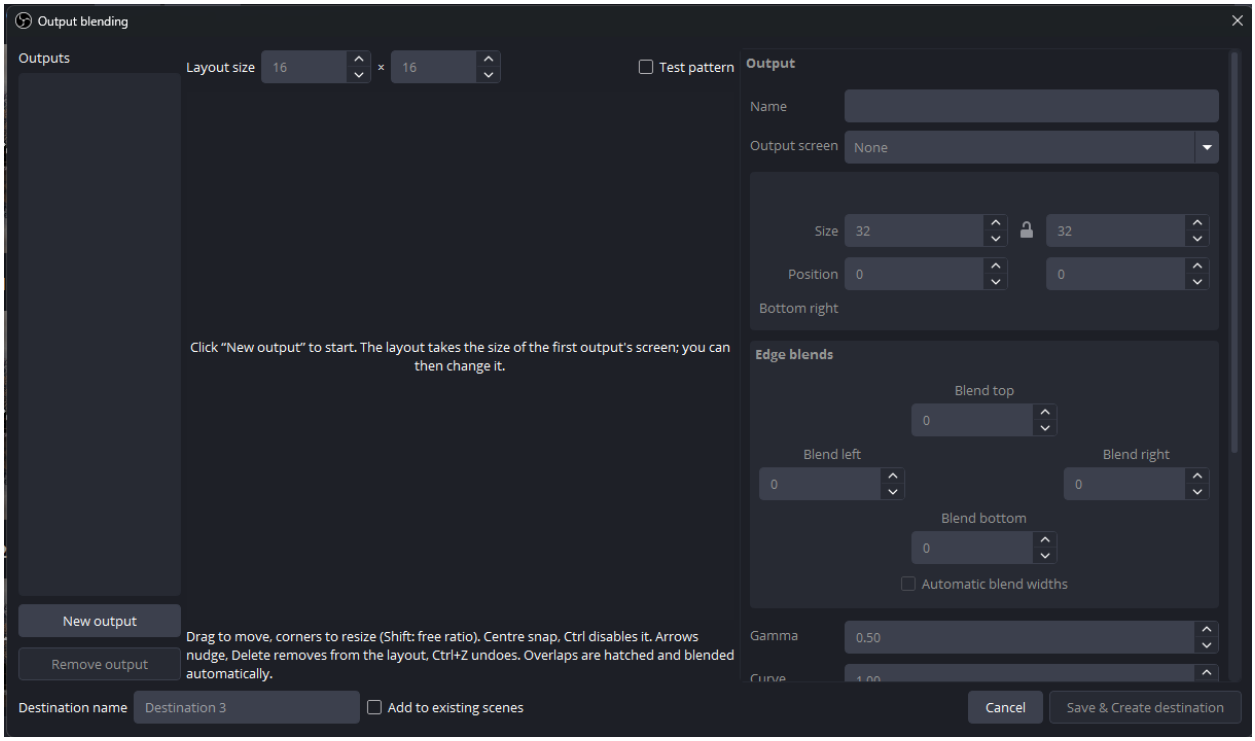


Figure 23. The Output blending window: the outputs, the layout, and the settings of the selected output (size with the aspect ratio lock, position, edge blends, gamma).

Placing outputs

Outputs are moved and resized with the mouse like sources: the centre snaps (Ctrl disables it), arrow keys nudge, Delete removes an output from the layout and Ctrl+Z undoes. The **lock** between width and height keeps the aspect ratio of the output when it is resized, with the mouse or by typing a size (on by default); Shift does the opposite while dragging. Position and size can also be typed in, and the bottom-right corner is shown; Enter confirms a value without closing the window. The edge blend widths are laid out like the edges of the output: top, left and right, bottom.

Blend settings

Setting	Use
Automatic blend widths	On: the blend zones follow the overlaps. Off: set Blend left, right, top and bottom by hand, in layout pixels.
Gamma	Matches the response of the projector so the blend is even (usually 1.8 to 2.4).
Curve	Shape of the fade: 1 is linear, higher values are softer in the middle.
Black level	Raises the black outside the overlaps, so the overlap does not look brighter on dark images.
Corner pin	Moves each corner of the output, in output pixels, to correct keystone. Reset corners restores them.
Test pattern	Replaces the picture with a grid and centre cross to align the projectors.

Adjusting live and saving

For an existing blended destination, open **Output blending…** from its submenu or from its Settings. **Open outputs** shows every output full screen on its projector, and every change appears there immediately. **Save changes** stores the settings (the button greys out once saved). If you **Close** with unsaved changes, you are asked whether to **Save changes** or **Discard changes**; discarding returns the projectors to the saved settings.



Figure 24. Two projectors showing the test pattern, aligned and blended.

> **Tip.** Start with the test pattern: align the projectors with the grid and corner pin, adjust the overlap, then the gamma, and finally the black level on a dark image.

11. Audio and media

The **Audio mixer** dock shows a strip per audio source with a level meter, a fader, a mute button and a monitoring menu (Monitor off, Monitor only, Monitor and output). It lists the active audio sources and those of the selected scene; **View all** shows every audio source. Audio is the OBS audio: it is mixed and sent once, with the default destination.

The **Media controls** dock controls the selected media source: play / pause, restart and stop, with its time.

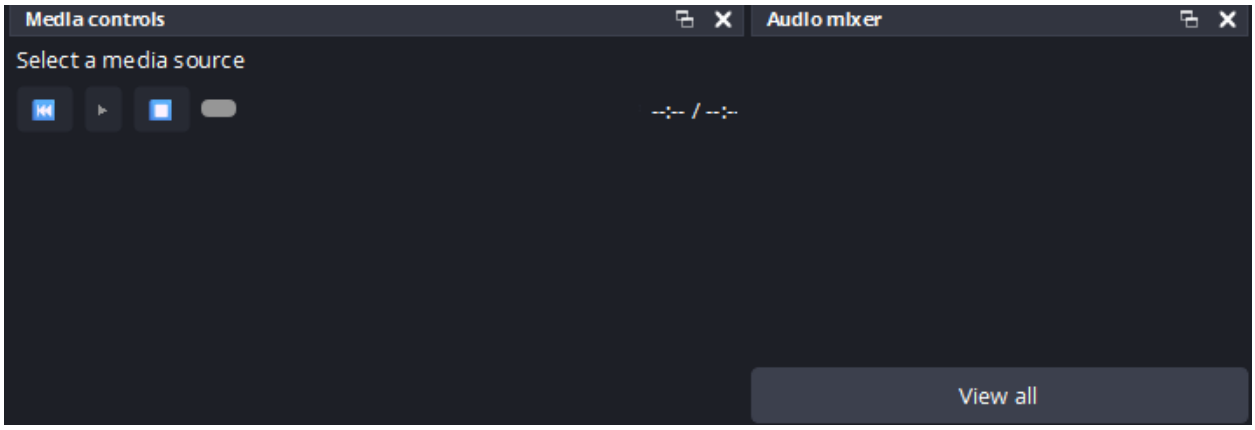


Figure 25. The Media controls and Audio mixer docks.

12. Companion and Stream Deck

Multidestination Studio comes with a version of Bitfocus Companion's **OBS Studio** module, **obs-studio-4.0.0-multidestination.3.tgz**, attached to every release. It is the full OBS Studio module plus a **Multidestination Studio** preset section, so a Stream Deck can drive the studio.

Installing the module

1. In OBS: **Tools → WebSocket Server Settings**, tick **Enable WebSocket server**, and note the port, the IP address and the password (**Show Connect Info**).
2. Download **obs-studio-4.0.0-multidestination.3.tgz** from the release. Do not unzip or rename it.
3. In Companion: **Modules → Import module package**, and choose the file. It is added as one more version of the OBS Studio module, named **4.0.0-multidestination.3**.
4. In **Connections**, add an OBS Studio connection with this version, or, if you already have one, **change its module version** from the official version to **4.0.0-multidestination.3**. Importing the module does not do this for you. Enter the address, port and password. The connection turns green.
5. In **Buttons → Presets → OBS**, open **Multidestination Studio** and drag the buttons onto your pages.

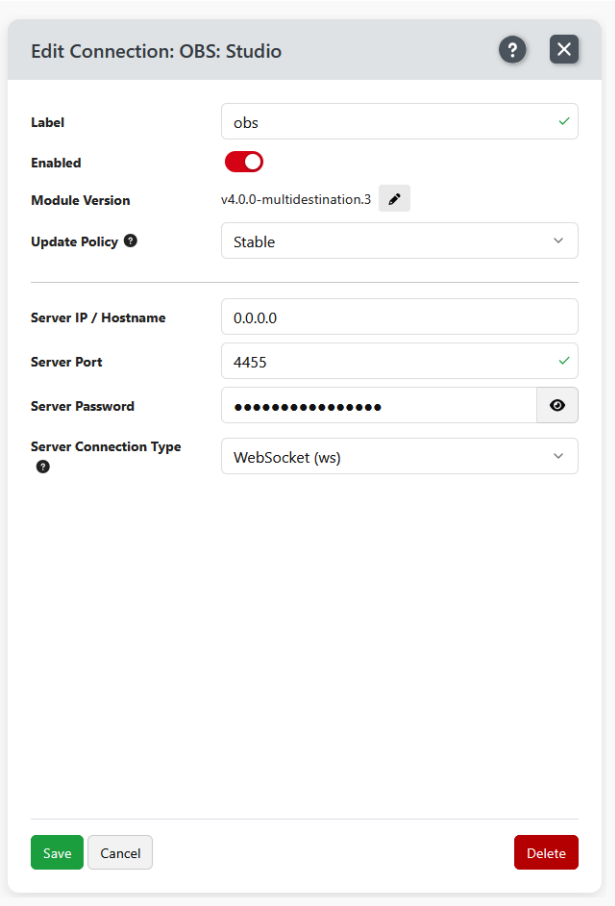


Figure 26. Companion: the OBS Studio module with version 4.0.0-multidestination.3.

The buttons

Preset	What it does	Colour
Scene to Preview	Shows the scene in the studio Preview (one button per scene)	Green in Preview, red in Program
Scene to Program	Puts the scene on air on every unlocked destination it covers	Green in Preview, red in Program
Transition	Takes the Preview to Program with the current transition	—
Transition With	Takes the Preview with that transition (one button per OBS transition)	—
After a Transition	Toggles “the previous Program returns to Preview”	Lit when on
Destinations Shown	Toggles all destinations / only those of the selected scene	Lit when on
Cue to Preview	Shows the cue in Preview; Transition then runs it (when Cues are on)	Green in Preview, red while running
Stop Cue	Stops the running cue with a fade to black	—
Running Cue Status	Running cue, step and time left; “No cue running” when idle	Red while a cue runs
Group	One per source group: shows the source shown; each press shows the next one, in Preview only (on air at the next transition)	—
Group: show …	One per source of each group: shows it and hides the others	Lit while shown

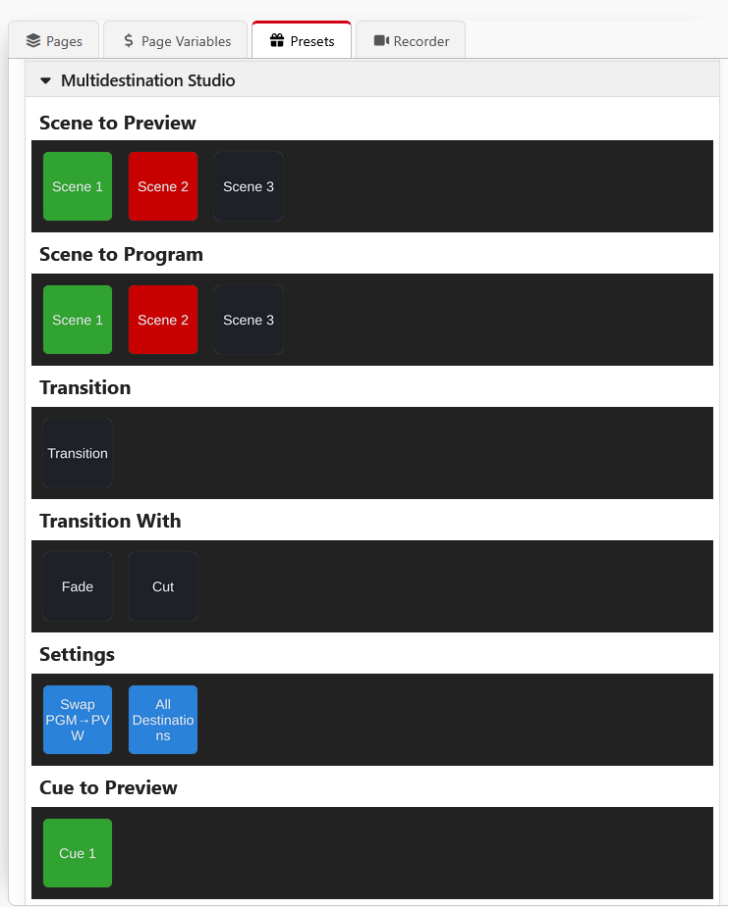


Figure 27. Companion: the Multidestination Studio presets.

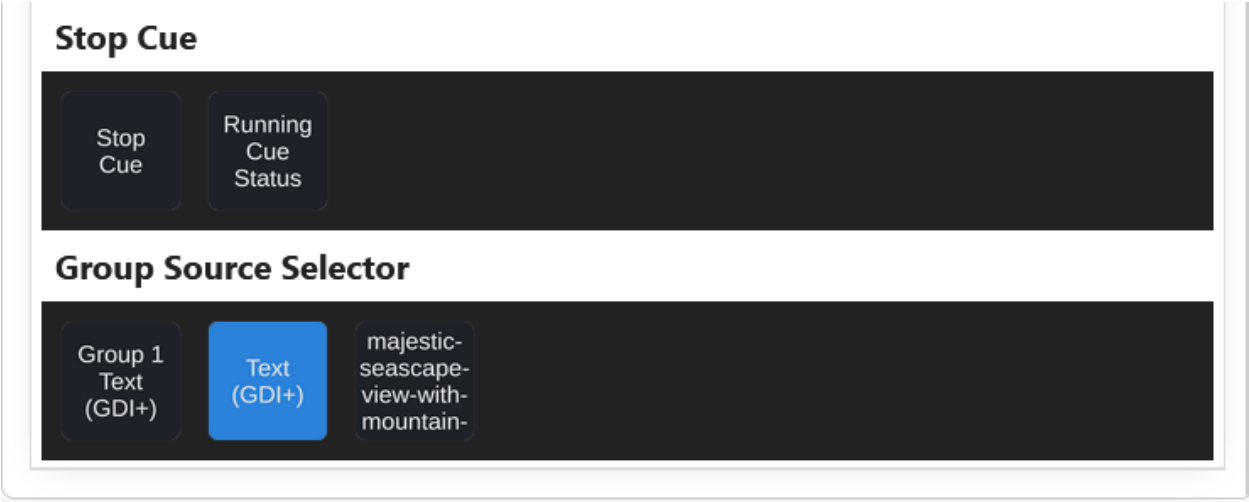


Figure 28. Companion: the Group Source Selector buttons and the Running Cue Status button on a page.

The buttons follow the studio live, and new scenes, transitions and cues appear in the presets by themselves. The same features exist as actions and feedbacks named **Multidestination Studio - …**. The plugin also answers obs-websocket vendor requests (vendor **multidestination-studio**) for other control software. The full guide is in the project repository (docs/companion-module.md).

Important. An existing OBS connection keeps the official version after the import: you must switch it to 4.0.0-multidestination.3 yourself, on every computer running Companion. In **Modules → OBS Studio**, the plug icon shows the version in use. Keep the connection on this version: an official version removes the Multidestination Studio buttons.

13. Configuration Settings

These settings apply to all your scene collections.

Setting	Choices
After a transition...	**The previous Program returns to Preview** (recommended, default), or **The scene sent live stays in Preview**, useful when your scenes do not cover the same destinations.
Destinations shown...	**All destinations, all the time** (recommended, default), or **Only the destinations of the selected scene**.
Cues...	**Activate Cues**: on or off (off by default). Shows the Cues dock (chapter 9).
Startup Settings...	**Launch Multidestination Studio on startup** and **Open every destination on its output screen at startup**: on or off (both off by default).
Language...	Same as OBS, English, Français or Norsk (Bokmål). Takes effect when OBS restarts.

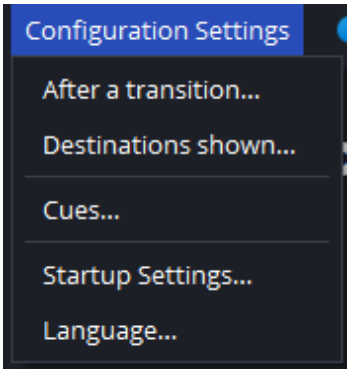


Figure 29. The Configuration Settings menu.

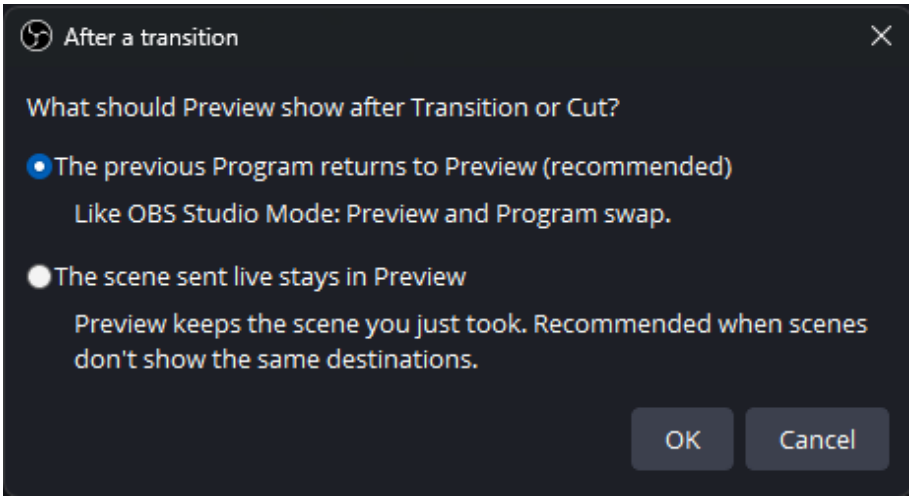


Figure 30. The After a transition dialog.

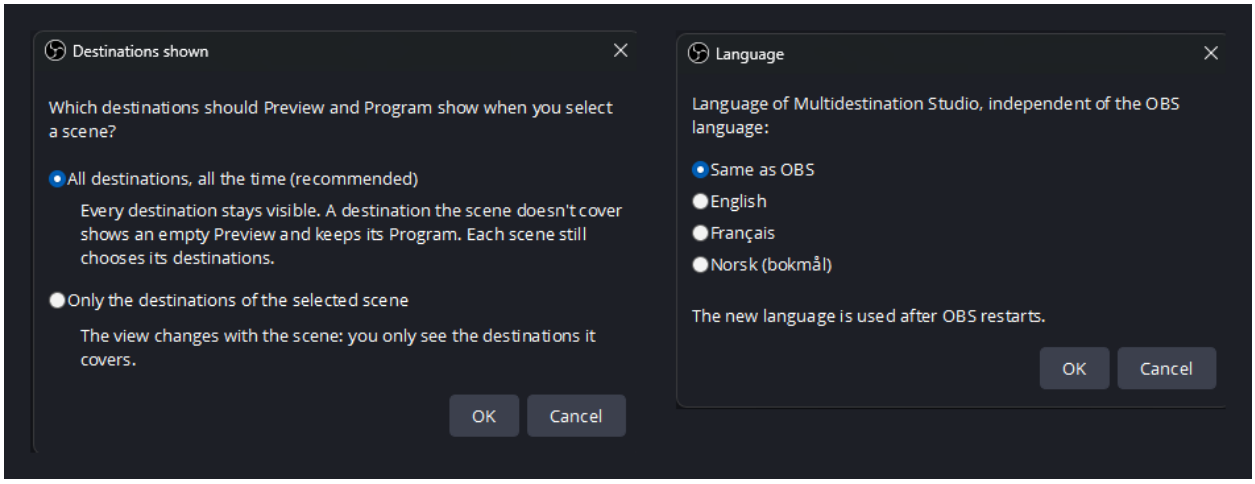


Figure 31. The Destinations shown and Language dialogs.

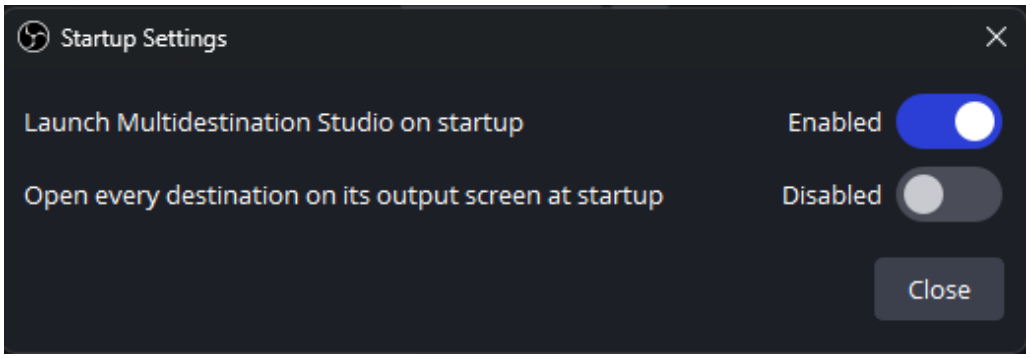


Figure 32. The Startup Settings dialog.

14. Saving, shortcuts and troubleshooting

What is saved, and where

- Destinations, their scenes and layouts, scene folders, cues, quick transitions, output blending and the dock arrangement are saved in the OBS **scene collection**. Switching collection switches all of them.
- Configuration Settings are saved in your OBS user settings and apply to every collection.

Shows

A **show** is an OBS scene collection with everything Multidestination Studio keeps in it. The **Show** menu manages them without going through the OBS window:

Command	What it does
New show…	Asks for a name and creates a new, empty scene collection, which becomes the loaded show. Set up its destinations and scenes as usual.
Save show	Saves the current state in the loaded show.
Save show as…	Saves the current state as a new show (OBS asks for its name) and loads it. The previous show stays as it was last saved.
Load show	Lists the shows; the loaded one is checked. Choosing another one loads it.
Import…	Opens the OBS importer to add a scene collection from a file (OBS or another program). When one show is added, you can load it right away.
Export…	Saves the loaded show to a .json file, with the OBS exporter.

When the show has changed, Multidestination Studio asks whether to save it: when you close the studio, when you quit OBS, and before New show or Load show. **Save** saves into the loaded show, **Don’t save** keeps the show as it was last saved, **Cancel** goes back. What is on air (Preview and Program scenes) does not count as a change.

- OBS itself keeps saving the scene collection while you work. With **Don’t save** at OBS exit or before loading another show, Multidestination Studio puts the show file back as it was last saved. When you close only the studio, **Don’t save** leaves your changes in OBS: you are asked again when OBS quits.
- Switching collection from the OBS **Scene Collection** menu keeps the OBS behaviour: the changes are saved without asking. If OBS stops unexpectedly, the latest changes are in the show.

Shortcuts at a glance

Key	Action
F11	Full screen on / off
Esc	Leave the studio; in a projection window (after clicking it), close the projection
Delete	Remove the selected scenes or sources (with confirmation)
F2 (Enter on macOS)	Rename the selected scene, folder, source or group
Ctrl+Z	Undo
Ctrl+G / Ctrl+Shift+G	Group selected sources / Ungroup
Arrow keys	Nudge the selected source or output
Shift (while resizing)	A source: free aspect ratio. An output: the opposite of its aspect lock
Ctrl+click (Cmd+click) in Preview	Select the whole group
Ctrl (while moving)	Disable centre snapping
Alt (on a handle)	Crop

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to check
The button does not appear in OBS	Check that OBS is 31.1 or later and reinstall with OBS closed. In OBS, Help → Log Files → View Current Log should contain lines starting with [multidestination-studio].
Windows blocks the installer	The installer is not code-signed. In SmartScreen choose More info → Run anyway; in Defender, allow the file from the protection history.
The studio was minimized	Click its entry in the taskbar (the Dock on macOS).
A destination stays empty	Check that the selected scene covers it and that it is not locked.
Transition is greyed out	A scene folder is selected: select a scene.
A group change is not on air	By design it goes on air with the next transition (chapter 8).
Open fullscreen is greyed out	Choose an output screen in the destination Settings, and check that the screen is connected.
No Multidestination Studio section in Companion	Most often the OBS connection still uses the official version: set its module version to 4.0.0-multidestination.3. Then check that it is green and that OBS runs with the plugin.
Companion refuses the module	Import the .tgz file itself (not a .zip); update Companion.
The interface is in the wrong language	Configuration Settings → Language, then restart OBS.